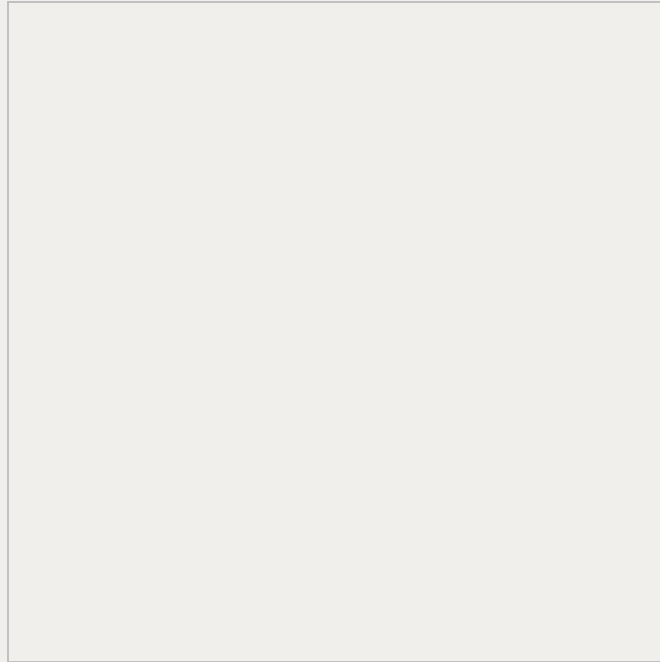


composers, who were active in southern Europe in the 12th century, and whose lyrics were sung, often by the poets themselves, sometimes with an instrumental accompaniment. Hildegard would also certainly have heard of the minnesänger, or minnesingers, traveling singers of northern Europe, and of their famous composer-performer Walther von der Vogelweide (c. 1170–c. 1230), who wrote poems on politics and love, and whose delightful and best-known work, “Under the Linden Tree,” resembles the song of a nightingale.



MINSTRELS, FROM THE CODEX OF THE
CANTIGAS DE SANTA MARIA, c. 1280